

unknown destinations. For instance, if you are travelling to Chennai from Delhi, you can locate all the popular restaurants, cinemas and other places via your smartphone. The route map will help you to travel to your desired destination easily. It is also possible to share the generated Maps with your friends and you also have the ability to embed those generated maps onto web pages, e-mails and social media platforms.

Quirks

The information produced by Google Maps is not completely accurate. The Maps are not updated on a daily basis. Hence, it is difficult to predict whether the roads are damaged by weather, blocked by demonstrations or any other unusual condition. The big problem with Google Maps is that the data is exposed to the outside world without any need for authentication. Hence, the chances of anti-social elements obtaining crucial location maps and other details is very high. Furthermore, the maps may contain materials which are offensive. In the past, Google had to remove several images and racist comments uploaded by users that were found to be of criminal nature. Moreover, you need access to high-speed WiFi or 4G connectivity to experience the full potential of the Google Maps app.

Competitors

Bing Maps is one of Google Maps' leading competitors. If you navigate to bing.com/maps, you will find a map of your current location. You can search for a specific location, manage directions and access traffic conditions. Even though a Bing app exists for Android, the lack of an exclusive Bing Maps app is an issue.

Apple Maps for iOS helps you explore locations with proactive suggestions. It also features indoor maps and the ability to interact with Siri to locate places. You can also explore flyovers with interactive 3D views.

Wikimapia is an excellent free alternative tool using which you can explore worldwide locations. The advantage of Wikimapia is that you can trim the results by category. If you select schools, you can view a list of all the schools near your locality.

Some other map related tools are Mapquest, yandex, waze and the Nav-Free Android app. You can find plenty of map related apps on the Play Store.

Google Street View

Google Street View helps you explore popular landmarks, natural won-